

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Amahl Farouk

OCCUPATION

Criminal

BASE

Various

HEIGHT Various

WEIGHT Various

EYES Various

HAIR Various

FIRST APPEARANCE

Uncanny X-Men #117

(January 1979)

An entity composed solely of malevolent psionic power, the Shadow King can possess others, bending them to his will. He also possesses various telepathic and telekinetic abilities.



SHADOW KING

The Shadow King is an immortal demon that has lived on the astral plane. It possesses people in the real world, making them fat as it feeds upon the hatred it breeds. In the '40s, it worked with BARON VON STRUCKER to try to replace King George VI of the UK with a Nazi puppet. Years later, the Shadow King appeared again as Amahl Farouk, an Egyptian crimelord and the first evil mutant PROFESSOR X ever met. At the time, Farouk's gang included a young thief that would one day become STORM. Professor X defeated Farouk in a psychic duel and believed him killed when he had only been banished back to the astral plane. A constant danger to Professor X and his X-MEN, the Shadow King remained an omnipresent threat to



Using his telepathic powers, Amahl Farouk became ruled Cairo's criminal underworld.

The Shadow King was the first mutant encountered by Professor X as he wandered the world, a tale told in *Uncanny X-Men* #117.

Xavier's dream of peaceful coexistence between mutants and normal humans. He once controlled a group of X-Men from a parallel world, dubbing them his Dark X-Men before EXCALIBUR defeated him. Recently, Bast, the Panther God of Wakanda, devoured the Shadow King for daring to attack the BLACK PANTHER and his wife Storm. **TB, MF**

SHADOWMASTERS

FIRST APPEARANCE *Shadowmasters* #1 (October 1989)

LINEUP Sojin Ezaki (deceased), Yuriko Ezaki, Phillip Richards

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Masters of ninjitsu

Demonstrating his martial arts skills, Phillip Richards wields a katana sword and *kyoketsu shoge* knife.



The original Shadowmasters were expert practitioners of the martial art of ninjitsu, who protected the Iga Province of Japan for centuries. Following the end of World War II, US Army Captain James Richards became friends with Shigeru Ezaki, one of the last Shadowmasters. Together they opposed renegade Japanese soldiers. Ezaki trained his children Sojin and Yuriko and Richards' son Phillip in martial arts. The renegades became the Sunrise Society, who killed James Richards and seemingly killed Shigeru Ezaki. Since then, Richards' son and Ezaki's children, as the new Shadowmasters, have opposed the Society, now renamed the Eternal Sun. **PS**

SHALLA-BAL

FIRST APPEARANCE *Silver Surfer* #1 (August 1968)

REAL NAME Shalla-Bal

OCCUPATION Empress of the planet Zenn-La BASE Zenn-La

HEIGHT 5 ft 9 in WEIGHT 125 lbs EYES Blue HAIR Black

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Born with no special powers.

Shalla-Bal was later invested with power to restore life to the soil of Zenn-La after it was devastated by Galactus.

Shalla-Bal is a member of an alien race, the Zenn-Lavians. She was separated from her lover, Norrin Radd, after he made a bargain with the world-eater GALACTUS, who had threatened to destroy Zenn-La. Radd offered to become the SILVER SURFER and serve GALACTUS if he would spare Zenn-La, and Galactus agreed. For years the Silver Surfer traveled the universe, scouting out uninhabited planets for Galactus to consume. When the Surfer eventually decided to abandon Galactus and remain on Earth, Shalla-Bal became caught up in his struggle with MEPHISTO.

Then Galactus returned to consume Zenn-La in revenge for the Surfer's betrayal. After the Surfer endowed Shalla-Bal with the power to restore life to Zenn-La, she was declared Empress, and so she remains to this day. **AD**

